NEPAL PARICHAYA SERIES · VOLUME II

Nepal Parichaya: History & Polity

Ancient Dynasties, Unification, Democratic Movements, and Republican Era

Department of Information & Reference Compendium

Historical Study Edition · 5 Pages

CHAPTER I · ANCIENT & CLASSICAL ERAS

Gopal, Kirat, and Licchavi Foundations

Chronicles trace early Kathmandu Valley governance to the Gopal and Mahishpal pastoral dynasties, succeeded by the Kirat period beginning with King Yalambar, under whom trans-Himalayan wool and herb trade expanded.

The Licchavi era (c. 400–750 CE) ushered in classical stone inscriptions, Sanskrit epigraphy, pagoda architecture, and administrative posts. Changunarayan pillar inscriptions of King Manadeva (464 CE) stand as the earliest dated historical epigraphs in the valley.

CHAPTER II · MEDIEVAL RENAISSANCE

The Malla Kingdoms and Urban Craftsmanship

From the twelfth to eighteenth centuries, the Malla rulers cultivated extraordinary urban planning, Newa metallurgy, woodcarving, stone water spouts (hiti), and codified social-legal reforms under Jayasthiti Malla.

After Yaksha Malla, the valley divided into three rival city-states—Kantipur, Lalitpur, and Bhaktapur—whose healthy artistic competition produced the Durbar Squares celebrated today.

CHAPTER III · UNIFICATION & SOVEREIGNTY

Modern Nation-State Consolidation

Initiated from Gorkha by King Prithvi Narayan Shah in 1743 CE (1800 BS), the unification campaign integrated fragmented principalities (Baise and Chaubise Rajya and the Valley kingdoms) into a resilient Himalayan state.

In his Divya Upadesh, Prithvi Narayan Shah articulated Nepals geopolitical doctrine as a yam between two boulders and emphasized domestic self-reliance, fair justice, and cultural pluralism.

CHAPTER IV · DEMOCRATIC TRANSFORMATIONS

2007 BS, 2046 BS, and 2062/63 BS Milestones

- 2007 BS (1951 CE): Popular revolution ended the 104-year Rana oligarchy and introduced interim constitutional governance.
- 2046 BS (1990 CE): Peoples Movement I restored multiparty parliamentary democracy and fundamental civil liberties.
- 2062/63 BS (2006 CE): Comprehensive Peace Accord and Peoples Movement II paved the way for Constituent Assembly elections.
- 3 Ashoj 2072 BS (20 Sept 2015): Promulgation of the Constitution of Nepal by the elected Constituent Assembly, institutionalizing a federal democratic republic.